



Discussion Guide: Kristin Du Mez

Confronting our Histories

Reflect

- When you hear the term “evangelicalism,” what comes to mind? Are your associations positive or negative? What experiences have informed these associations?
- As Kristin points out in her book *Jesus and John Wayne*, when a religious tradition is met with critique, leaders and practitioners of that tradition can sometimes become defensive. Where have you seen this in your own experience? What are the drawbacks of this response?
- Kristin notes that in certain evangelical communities, the term “family values” implies white patriarchal authority. Where have you seen “family values” and white patriarchal authority being confused or conflated in society or politics? In churches? How would you define “family values”?

Respond

- Kristin describes a “religious excavation” assignment she gives to her students in which students explore the history of their family or denomination. Have you ever learned something surprising about your family history and/or faith tradition? How did this discovery impact you and your faith?
- Attorney and advocate Rachael Denhollander has said, “The gospel of Jesus Christ does not need your protection. Jesus only asks for obedience. And what does obedience look like? It looks like telling the truth and pursuing justice. That is all.” To what extent do you agree with this quote? Is there anything you would add to it? How can you prioritize telling the truth and pursuing justice in your life and in your faith community?

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